

be proactive"

no project would be blocked for unnecessary reasons.

Q. Any fear of the independents ditching you?

A. We have their full cooperation. There is no threat from that quarter at all.

Q. How do you plan to allay the fears of minorities?

A. They have nothing to fear. We are going to carry everybody along with us in developing this state. My only agenda is development for the state.

Q. How will you tackle the border disputes, Hogenakkal or Cauvery type of issues?

A. With good monsoons, we don't expect problems with the Cauvery issue but we will go by the law of the land regarding the Hogenakkal issue.

Q. Are you carrying the weight of expectations being south India's first BJP chief minister?

A. No, except a desire to try and fulfil the promises that we made in the manifesto.

Q. Bangalore, the state capital, is known the world over, but everything seems to be in a shambles.

A. We will address the infrastructure issues concerning the city on a war footing. My Government will lend all support to the country's IT capital. We will implement the recommendations of the Dr K. Kasturirangan Committee on Bangalore and I am keen to turn it into a world class city, not just an IT or a BT city but it must be a model of development for other cities too. As I said in my speeches during the campaign, for me my people, the citizens are the top priority and I will do whatever is necessary to make their lives easier and better.

B K RAMESH



DIVIDED HOUSE:
S.M. Krishna
flanked by senior
Congress leaders

ty's contributions cut little ice with a young electorate that refuses to live in the past. BJP, on the other hand, held more than 120 public meetings, with several national leaders—including Leader of the Opposition L.K. Advani, party President Rajnath Singh and spokesperson Sushma Swaraj—in attendance. Their message was the same: vote for stability, elect Yeddyurappa. There was no witchhunt for the Gowdas, only the promise of clean and efficient administration for the next five years. Nearly 30,000 booth-level committees of the party played a key role in reaching out to voters with the "one booth, 10 youth" principle. BJP tapped the youth—both volunteers and the gainfully employed—in large numbers for its work.

On May 25, as counting progressed, the divergent moods in the three main camps began to show. At the JD(S) office, not a soul stirred. Gowda took refuge in his residence with Kumaraswamy, who had announced before the results that

he wouldn't merely be a kingmaker this time, but the king. In the morning, Kumaraswamy had told the press that his party would under no circumstances shake hands with the Congress. By evening, however, he was talking of a strong Opposition to what he termed a "communal party in power". Since the results have been announced, Gowda has not made a single public appearance, sending a party spokesperson to a press conference on May 27 despite initial reports that he would address the media himself. Ignoring the fact that it was because of their party that Karnataka suffered political uncertainty throughout the last two years, JD(S) spokesmen are now blaming the Congress for handing over the Government to BJP on a platter, at the same time not ruling out an understanding with it to form a strong Opposition.

For the Congress, it was a bolt from the blue. That soon gave way to soul-searching, as it acknowledged that it was largely due to its inability to proj-

